

agency, claiming: "A system for the support of indigent persons in the United States was never contemplated by the authors of the Constitution," but he failed to stop the agency's work.

The political feud between the Radical Republicans and Johnson culminated in an attempt to impeach the president in 1868. The Republicans used the Tenure of Office Act, which they had passed the year before. This prevented the president from removing from office anyone who had been appointed by a past president unless the Senate ratified his decision. Johnson had suspended his secretary of war, Edwin Stanton, and when the Senate failed to ratify his decision, he was impeached. He survived Senate conviction by a single vote, but was now virtually powerless.